

Character Arc Tracking: Inciting Incident Initiation Matrix

A matrix analyzing the park fountain crisis, mapping actions, emotional reactions, and immediate shifts in character motivation.

Name: _____ Date: _____ Class Period: _____

Character	Immediate Action Taken (Physical choices/responses)	Emotional Reaction (Psychological state during crisis)	Shift in Motivation (New immediate trajectory or goal)
Ponyboy Curtis			
Johnny Cade			
Secondary Focus (e.g., Dally / Bob / Socs)			

Synthesis & Textual Analysis Prompt:

How does the fountain crisis fundamentally alter the dynamic between Ponyboy and Johnny? Explain how Johnny's physical decision forces an immediate shift in Ponyboy's perception of safety, law, and group loyalty.